

7.10.3 Desktop Homepage

The Desktop home page enables you to search the Desktop as well as browse items based on their date and time. To view chronological details of files, click on the “Browse Timeline” link. You can click on the calendar on the right to navigate to any date where files have been created, indexed, or viewed through GD.

Like with regular GD search, you can also filter your searches to show only e-mail, files, Web history and chats.

You can also find out the current status of indexing by clicking on the Index Status link. The preferences page can also be accessed by clicking on the Preferences link next to the GD search box. Similar to other Google search products and services, you also have an Advanced Search page that enables you to control what should be searched, what words should be included and excluded, between what date ranges, and across which computers. See §7.10.6 for details on the advanced search operators you can use.

7.10.4 Quick Find

Quick Find is an instantaneous find feature that displays search results as you type, saving you time and increasing the efficiency of your searches. Quick Find will display the first six results and will indicate how many more results are available to be viewed in the browser. You need to enable Quick Find from **Preferences > Display** before you can use it with your Deskbar, Sidebar, or the Quick Search Box. Quick Find can also be used to launch applications. Just type in the starting letters of any application installed on your computer and Quick Find will display those in the results. In the example below, Quick Find is used to “find” the anti-spyware application Spybot Search & Destroy.

You can type URLs into the search box to directly jump to a site. Right-click on any result to open that file’s parent folder. Quick Find also enables you to use the shortcut keys **[Windows] + [G]** or **[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [G]** to quickly access the Sidebar or Deskbar or the GD home page, depending on your GD configuration.

By default, if you immediately press **[Enter]** after typing your search term, Quick Find will search the Web, opening the results in a Web browser. By clicking on the Search More link, you can also search across other Google products and services.

Applications and Control Panel items can be accessed quickly by typing the first few letter of the item’s name. For example, typing “Sound” will show you listing for the Sound management applications on your computer as well as the Control Panel Sound applet.

7.10.5 The Quick Search Box

The quick search box is by the far the fastest and simplest way to access GD. After activating it from your **Preferences > Display** page, simply press **[Ctrl]** twice to bring the Quick Search box to the front of the screen. Enter your search terms, and if you have also activated Quick Find, the results will be displayed as you type.

7.10.6 Advanced Search Operators

Most of the search operators used on Google are also valid in GD. These and other operators valid on GD are:

Phrase Search: You can use quotes to search for the exact phrase. Example: “hi dad”.

Exclude from Search: Use the minus sign to exclude the keyword from your search results. Like with Google Web search, ensure that there is a space before the minus sign and no space between it and the keyword that needs to be excluded.

site: and filetype: operators work in the same way as on Google Web search.

under: This operator restricts the keyword search to a specified folder. Example: cricket under:”C:\My Documents” will search for documents with the keyword “cricket” in My Documents.

machine: This operator restricts the search to a specific computer. Example: Airtel machine:MYLAPTOP will search for documents with the word “Airtel” on the computer MYLAPTOP.